



FIYMA Program

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Safeguarding Requirements, Commitments and Implementation Approaches

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Safeguarding Objectives

- Ensure freedom from harm in all program activities
- Promote safe participation in financial systems
- Strengthen institutional accountability
- Embed responsible business conduct and client protection

Safeguarding Requirements: All implementing entities must have:

- Safeguarding risk assessments
- Reporting and incident management systems
- Safe recruitment procedures
- Staff code of conduct
- Accountability mechanisms
- Data protection compliance

Safeguarding Context & Rationale

The FIYMA Program targets **financially disadvantaged youth**, especially young women, persons with disabilities, and refugees.

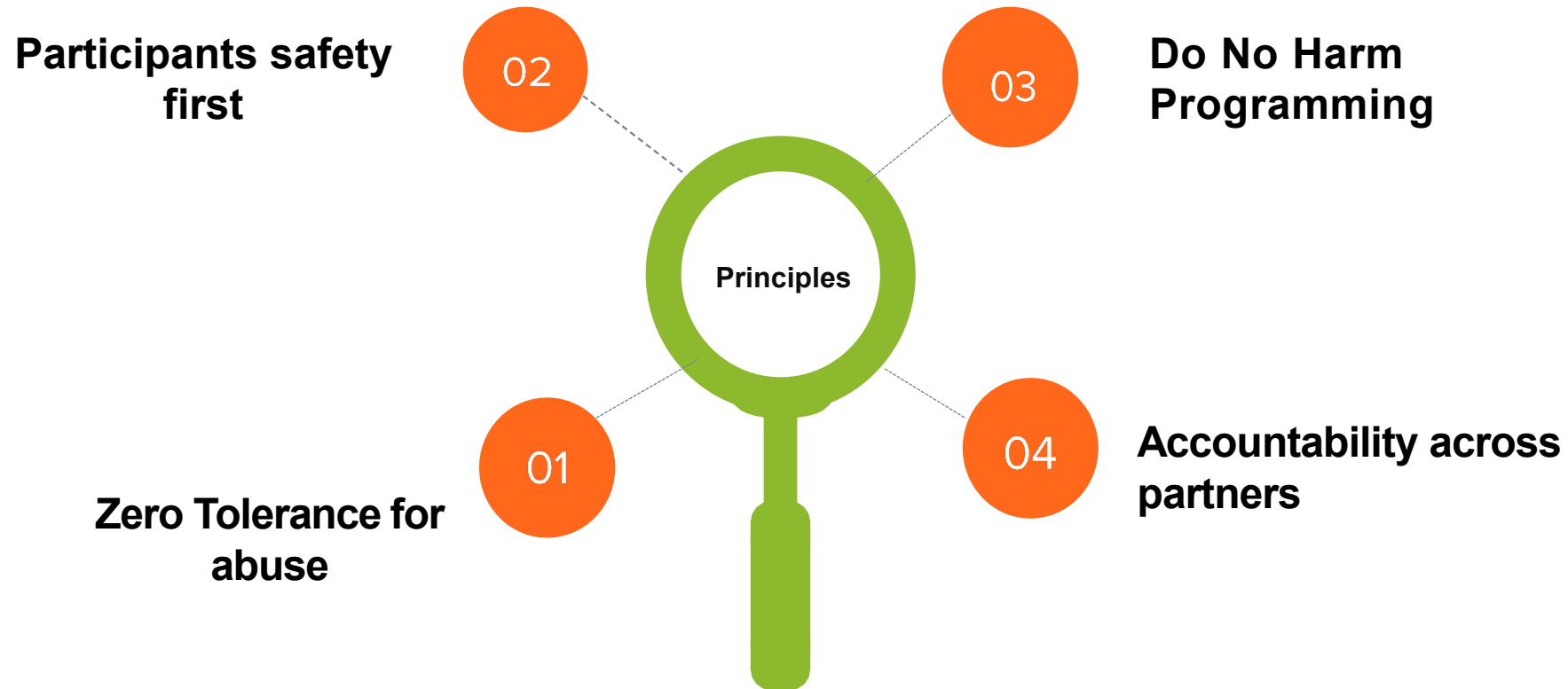
All program participants are considered **persons at risk**.

Risks arise from:

- Financial exclusion
- Gender inequality, disability, and refugee status
- Informality and weak institutional systems

Safeguarding is **central to program design and delivery**.

Mastercard Foundation Safeguarding Commitment



Safeguarding Commitments

The FIYMA Program commits to:

- Establish safeguarding governance and accountability frameworks
- Implement client protection principles

Adopt:

- Safeguarding policies
- Codes of conduct
- Reporting and whistleblowing systems

Mainstream safeguarding across:

- SACCOs
- Cooperatives
- MSMEs
- Partner Institutions

Safeguarding Implementation Approach

1. System Strengthening

- Develop safeguarding policies & frameworks
- Institutionalize responsible business conduct

2. Capacity Building Training on:

- Safeguarding
- Client protection
- Gender responsiveness

3. Continuous Monitoring

- Safeguarding integrated into MEAL systems
- Regular supervision and compliance checks

Safeguarding Structure & Roles

Women Empowerment Link (WEL)

- Lead partner for safeguarding and gender inclusion

MESPT

- Overall accountability for safeguarding implementation

SACCOs nominate **safeguarding focal points**

Dedicated roles:

- Gender & Youth Inclusion (MESPT)
- Safeguarding focal persons (SACCO level)

Risk Management and Mitigation

- Pre-activity **safeguarding risk assessments**
- Identify gender-based and financial exploitation risks
- Apply mitigation measures before execution

Accountability and Reporting Mechanism

- Whistleblowing platforms
- Incident reporting systems
- Regular audits and monitoring
- MEAL framework integration

Purpose of the FIYMA Program Safeguarding Guidelines

- **Framework for Participant Protection:** The guidelines provide a framework to protect safety, dignity, and rights of all program participants and stakeholders.
- **Zero-Tolerance to Abuse:** The FIYMA Program enforces zero-tolerance on abuse, exploitation, and discrimination through active prevention and decisive action.
- **Risk Mitigation Focus:** The guidelines emphasize proactive risk identification and controls in financial, agribusiness, and community settings.
- **Consistency and Accountability:** They ensure consistent safeguarding standards and accountability across all consortium partners and actors.

Statement of Principles Guiding Safeguarding

Ethical and Legal Foundation: Safeguarding is grounded in international and national human rights laws ensuring dignity and justice for all.

Equality and Non-Discrimination: All individuals have the right to live free from abuse, requiring tailored protections for vulnerable groups.

Best Interests and Accountability: Decisions prioritize participant safety and wellbeing, enforcing zero tolerance for abuse and responsible action

Scope and Applicability of the Safeguarding Guidelines

- **Comprehensive Coverage:** Guidelines apply to all partners and individuals involved in program delivery ensuring broad protection.
- **Policy Adoption and Standards:** Consortium partners must implement safeguarding policies that meet or exceed the FIYMA Program minimum standards.
- **Capacity Building and Awareness:** Regular training and awareness initiatives are mandatory for all personnel and third parties involved.
- **Integration Into Operations:** Safeguarding is embedded in governance, partnerships, and daily program activities to ensure accountability

Minimum Guidelines and Reporting Mechanisms

- **Preventive Safeguarding Measures:** Guidelines focus on prevention through risk assessments, safe recruitment, gender equality, and participant involvement to reduce abuse risks.
- **Accessible Reporting Channels:** Multiple confidential channels like in-person, email, phone, and whistleblowing platforms support survivor-centered reporting without requiring proof.
- **Structured Incident Management:** Incident handling includes timely acknowledgment, investigation, decision-making, corrective action, and feedback ensuring confidentiality and safety.
- **Continuous Learning and Improvement:** Safeguarding data and trends are analyzed to improve policies, trainings, and risk mitigation strategies for long-term program strength.

Safeguarding Outputs and Outcomes

Expected results:

- Safer financial ecosystems
- Increased trust in institutions
- Improved participation of:
 - Young women
 - Vulnerable youth

Reduced risks of:

- Exploitation
- Harm



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